

A CONSTITUTIONAL TEXT

THE ELEMENTAL PROPERTIES OF TRUE

IN THIS TEXT, THE HUBBELL METHOD IS
PROCLAIMED

*“True is what remains answerable to what it is,
where it came from, and what it is entitled to
authorize.”*



WHEELER HUBBELL

Preamble: The Difference Between a Word and Its Force

Everything that moves is changed by the fact of movement.

A word passes from speech to record. A record passes from its occasion to an account made years later. A condition becomes a rule. A possibility becomes an accusation. A fragment becomes a verdict. A report becomes a decision. A decision becomes an inheritance. Each passage changes the field in which the thing is used, and each passage asks whether the thing may retain the force it possessed in its original place.

This is so common that it is mistaken for harmless. It is not harmless. A statement may be accurate and still insufficient. A record may be authentic and no longer current. A conclusion may be elegantly reasoned and still exceed the material entitled to support it. A rule may survive its originating circumstance while losing the jurisdiction that once made it sensible. These failures look unlike one another only until their structure is seen. In each, something has been detached from the conditions that gave it standing and has been asked to authorize more than it can.

Truth is not a tone of voice. It is not a reward conferred by confidence, age, status, repetition, fluency, fear, or force. In a governed sense, true is what remains answerable to what it is, where it came from, the conditions under which it holds, the limits that travel with it, and the action it is actually entitled to authorize.

This book is not a catalogue of truths. It is an account of what must travel with a claim if that claim is to remain itself. It does not command every conclusion. It governs the passage by which conclusions become allowed to act. It asks not only whether a sentence is compelling, but what the sentence is, what work it is permitted to do, and what it would take to move it lawfully from one state to another.

The work begins where confidence ends: at the edge between what the record establishes and what someone wishes it established. That edge is not a failure of thought. It is the place from which accountable thought begins.

CONSTITUTIONAL STATEMENT

No claim acquires force merely by moving. Every material increase in force requires a basis that can be inspected.